

Flash memory woes

A recent report claims that flash memory, not network hassles, damage most smartphones, according to a research

Govt to track cell phones

Indian government has said that it will track locations of all cell phone users in the country, according to a daily <http://bit.ly/wiPrpU>



Consumer laptops (Ultrabooks)

Brand	Acer	Apple	Asus	Lenovo	HP
Model	Aspire S3	MacBook Air 11	Zenbook UX31E	IdeaPad U300s	Folio 13
Price (₹)	50900	67900	99999	67990	69990
Features (so 30)	13.63	12.57	14.52	13.06	12.96
Overall (so 100)	46.64	56.17	55.53	60.35	65.81
Processor	Intel Core i5-2467M	Intel Core i5-2567M	Intel Core i7-2677M	Intel Core i5-2467M	Intel Core i5-2467M
Speed (MHz)	1600	1600	2600	2000	1600
RAM (DDR3)	4 GB	4 GB	4 GB	4 GB	4 GB
Graphics	Intel HD Graphics	Intel HD 3000 Graphics	Intel HD 3000 Graphics	Intel HD 3000 Graphics	Intel HD 3000 Graphics
HDD	320 SSD	128 SSD	256 SSD	128 SSD	128 SSD
OS	Windows 7 HP 64-bit	Mac OS X Lion	Windows 7 HP 64-bit	Windows 7 HP 64-bit	Windows 7 HP 64-bit
Screen Size (Inches)	13.3	11	13.3	13.3	13.3
Type of Panel	LED backlit	LED backlit	LED backlit	LED backlit	LED backlit
Screen Resolution (Pixels)	1366x768	1366x768	1600x900	1366x768	1366x768
Weight (kg)	1.35 kg	1.08 kg	1.3 kg	1.33 kg	1.5 kg
No of Ports (USB/Firewire)	2/0	2/0	2/0	2/0	2/0
No of USB 3.0 (Y/N)	0	0	1	1	0
Connectivity (LAN / Bluetooth / Wi-Fi)	Y/Y/Y	N/Y/Y	Y/Y/Y	Y/Y/Y	Y/Y/Y
E-Sata / Thunderbolt (Y/Y)	N/N	N/Y	N/N	N/N	N/N
Display (VGA/DVI/HDMI/Display Port)	Y/N/Y/N	N/N/N/N	N/N/Y/Y	N/N/Y/N	N/N/Y/N
Headphone/Mic	Y/Y	Y/Y	Y/Y	Y/Y	Y/Y
Memory Card Reader (Y/N)	Y	N	Y	N	Y
Fingerprint scanner?	N	N	N	N	N
Optical Drive (Y/N)	N	N	N	N	N
Inbuilt Webcam (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Design & Usability (so 30)	16.13	21.94	17.25	21.94	21.19
Performance (so 40)	16.89	21.66	23.77	25.35	31.66
PCMark Vantage Score	5244	8713	8270	9147	9205
Memory Score	2990	4620	4472	1921	4944
TV and Movies Score	3102	3098	3958	3703	3841
Gaming Score	3618	6705	7166	6590	7268
Music Score	4525	10384	9732	10317	10402
Communications Score	7216	7856	7195	9704	10094
Productivity Score	4554	10545	11932	10321	12259
HDD Score	2645	18289	13641	20599	26072
3D Mark 06 Score	3280	4232	3656	3457	3453
Maxxon Cinebench R11.5 (CPU Score)	1.94	1.95	2.3	1.93	1.95
Battery Meter (in mins)	132	124	113	168	280
Speaker volume (at 50%)	5	5.5	6	7	7
Speaker clarity (at 100%)	5	6	6.5	6.5	7
HD video playback test (So 10)	6.5	5.5	7.5	7.5	7.5
4GB single file copy (secs)	179	73	51	53.7	45.1
4GB folder files copy (sec)	230	140.9	116.2	89.1	53.7
100 MB File Conversion (VOB-to-DivX) (secs)	59	44	36	44.7	44

lids, the HP Folio 13 and Asus Zenbook up the ante a bit with a brushed finish that feels excellent on touch.

Despite their razor thin dimensions, all the featured ultrabooks have good build quality – although, we think the Acer Aspire S3 could be a little more rugged, but there its super-slim profile is to blame more than anything else. Another common thread across all the ultrabooks currently is their form factor – all four ultrabooks have a 13.3-inch screen, with the Asus Zenbook sporting the highest resolution screen at 1600x900 pixels.

All ultrabooks sport locked battery compartments that can't just be pulled out, a feature common with all Apple MacBooks, not just the MacBook Air, for at least three years. There's no room to slot in an additional battery pack for greater charge.

Features and Performance

Apart from the 11-inch MacBook Air, all four ultrabooks featured in this comparison feature recently launched 2nd-gen Core i5 and Core i7 processors, especially for use on ultrabooks only. None of the ultrabooks have an optical drive or separate mouse buttons on their trackpad. All ultrabooks come with at least two USB ports, audio jacks and one output video port. Out of all the ultrabooks, we really liked the typing experience on the Lenovo IdeaPad U300s and the HP Folio 13 keyboards. No problem with the Acer Aspire S3's keyboard and trackpad, but the Asus Zenbook's trackpad and mouse buttons are just plain difficult to use.

All ultrabooks managed to achieve the 2-hour mark in our